HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "This is the only thing that makes me feel okay, and nothing else will work."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"This is the only thing that makes me feel okay, and nothing else will work." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I actually tried, and what have I only imagined would fail?
- ☐ Is "I cannot feel another way" the same as "no other way exists"?
- ☐ Who is one person or helper I have not given a real chance?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend who said nothing else will ever work?
- ☐ Where is God in the sentence "nothing else"?
- ☐ If I am thinking about dying, who will I tell today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ This is not the only thing that can help me. God is near, other help exists, and I can ask even when I cannot feel that yet.
- ☐ Feeling like nothing else will work is not proof that nothing will.
- ☐ I am allowed to want to feel okay.
- ☐ God is near me in this, not waiting for me to fix it first.
- ☐ A doctor, a counselor, and other people can help.
- ☐ I do not have to feel hopeful before I ask.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 42:11
  "Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him, my Savior and my God."
- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"

☐ Psalm 34:18

"The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When nothing else seemed able to help: Each day, write down one moment when you felt this was the only way to feel okay. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 42:11 becomes: "James can write: "My soul is downcast, and I will yet hope in God. This is not my only help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] If you want to die, call or text 988 or tell someone near you now. Do that before any other step.
- [ ] Tell one helper the sentence "nothing else will work," and let them answer. A counselor, a doctor, or 1-800-662-4357.
- [ ] Do not stop suddenly to force another way to work. Ask a doctor what is safe.
- [ ] Read Psalm 42:11 out loud, including the word "yet."

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "This is the only thing that makes me feel okay, and nothing else will work.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A help I did not dismiss
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~This is the only thing that makes me feel okay, and nothing else will work~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my soul is downcast, and I have believed nothing else will work. You are my Savior and my God. Give me help I cannot feel yet, and keep me alive to receive it. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.